

# The Boston Globe

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## Brown University makes a deal with Trump

Millions in research funding restored, with various stipulations

By Alexa Gagosz  
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — Brown University has reached an agreement with the Trump administration to restore the university's federal research funding and address allegations that it failed to do enough to stop the harassment of Jewish students, according to a copy of the agreement viewed by the Globe.

In exchange for the restoration of nearly \$50 million in research grants, Brown will pledge \$50 million over the next 10 years to state workforce development organizations in Rhode Island.

The deal, which was finalized Wednesday, settles three open investigations into the university, and does not require the Ivy League institution to admit any wrongdoing or make a payment to the federal government.

This deal is unlike the Trump administration's recent settlement with Columbia University, which will pay more than \$220 million to restore federal research money that was canceled by the Trump administration in the name of combating antisemitism on campus following the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas attack on Israel. Education Secretary Linda McMahon called the

**BROWN UNIVERSITY, Page A7**

## Lawmakers conference requires some big bucks

Mass. legislators solicit corporations to fund it

By Samantha J. Gross and Matt Stout  
GLOBE STAFF

Thousands of lawmakers and policy makers from across the country will descend on Boston Monday for three days of networking, programming, and socializing for what Massachusetts legislative leaders likened to a "World Cup"-level event.

Those same Massachusetts lawmakers have also been asking corporations and others with interests before the Legislature to fork over as much as \$250,000 each to help fund the celebration.

For months, Massachusetts lawmakers have been raising money for the National Conference of State Legislatures Legislative Summit, which the bipartisan organization bills as the "nation's largest gathering of legislators and legislative staff" and this year also commemorates its 50th anniversary.

How much they're ultimately seeking to raise for the event is unclear. Massachusetts legislators behind the fund-raising push either declined or did not respond to questions about their fund-raising goal. Nor are lawmakers mandated to detail whom they solicited, and

**LAWMAKERS, Page A7**

## Pressed, Fed chair holds line

Interest rates remain steady as Powell refuses again to bow to Trump's wishes

By Jim Puzzanghera  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell on Wednesday held firm against President Trump's unprecedented public pressure campaign to lower interest rates amid continued uncertainty over tariffs, but there are signs a cut could come in September.

The Fed's monetary policy committee kept its benchmark rate steady at between 4.25 percent and 4.5 percent, as analysts and investors expected. But cracks started to show in the consensus of central bankers. Two of the 11 members voting on Wednesday — both Trump appointees — dissented because they wanted to reduce the rate by a mod-

est quarter percentage point. It was the first double dissent by Fed governors in more than 30 years.

Powell downplayed the votes and said most committee members still want to see more economic data about the impact of tariffs on inflation before lowering rates, which risk accelerating price increases.

"We are learning more and more," Powell said after the interest rate decision was announced. "It doesn't feel like we're very close to the end of that process."

Recent trade deals with Japan and the European Union, along with an upbeat report Wednesday on US economic growth, have lifted some of the uncertainty about the effect of Trump's push for higher tariffs. Now, a rate cut such as the quarter percentage point reduction sought by the two dissenters is looking more possible at the Fed's next meeting in mid-September.

Still, Powell continues to operate on his own timetable, not Trump's.

**POWELL, Page A6**



DAVID L. RYAN/ GLOBE STAFF

Lawrence Brown was in line to get an air conditioner as part of a Harvard study, but he had to go without until recently.

## WHEN THE HEAT IS ON, FROZEN FUNDING HITS HOME

With Harvard projects on hold, some Boston residents suffer without AC

By Liz Kowalczyk  
GLOBE STAFF

It was 90 degrees outside and the air was steamy and thick, yet it felt even hotter in Lawrence Brown's tiny third-floor walkup. The breeze from a rotating floor fan fluttered a pile of folded laundry in the living room but provided little relief.

Brown, 61, landed a one-bedroom unit in a brick public housing complex in Dorchester five years ago, following a downturn in his life that included the death of his wife from cancer, and a bout of homelessness. He is grateful for a roof over his head, but in summer it has a major drawback: no air conditioning.

For someone like Brown, who suffers from a lung disease that makes it hard to breathe, it's more than just miserable — it's also a health risk.

One hundred Boston residents were supposed to receive a window unit as early as June as part of a Harvard University study of making air conditioning more widely accessible, especially to those with medical conditions, as summers grow hotter and more humid.

But as part of its far-reaching assault on the university, the Trump administration rescinded the money for the project. As a result, some residents, including Brown, received their units late, while others won't get them at all.

"It really breaks my heart that yesterday was the day that folks could have really benefited from already having an air conditioner," Gary Adamkiewicz, the project's leader and an associate professor of environmental health at the Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health, said in June after tempera-

tures hit 102 degrees. "I was praying that the first heat wave in Boston would hold off until mid-July."

As the Trump administration erased \$3 billion in federal funding to Harvard this year as punishment for what it calls liberal bias and an alleged failure to protect Jewish students from antisemitism, the public health school was especially hard hit. The school depends on the federal government for 40 percent of its budget, and Washington's actions have upended the work of researchers, slowing or stopping projects that reach into the day-to-day lives of Americans trying to improve their situation in the most basic ways.

"People think of research as this ivory tower thing, just to learn for the sake of learning," said Jonathan Levy, chair of the

**CONDITIONING, Page A10**



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

**PECKING ORDER** — It's been a sizzling week in Boston, and at Franklin Park Zoo, animals needed a little extra attention as they dealt with the heat. Frozen banana treats were on the menu for a kea on Wednesday, but it looks like things will cool off Thursday. **B1.**

## Bar advocates are cool to pay-raise proposal

By Sean Cotter and Samantha J. Gross  
GLOBE STAFF

Beacon Hill leaders unveiled a proposal Wednesday to increase pay for private attorneys who represent indigent criminal defendants, an effort to end a work stoppage that has disrupted the courts and led to the early release of dozens of defendants and the dismissal of more than 100 cases.

In addition to raising the pay for so-called bar advocates by \$10 an hour this year, and again by \$10 an hour next year, the proposal would dramatically expand the number of salaried public defenders so

the courts would be less reliant on private attorneys and less vulnerable to work stoppages.

"What we are doing over a two-year period is giving a significant pay raise to the bar advocates," said House Ways and Means Chair Aaron Michlewitz, a North End Democrat. "We feel that no one ever gets 100 percent in what they ask for, but this is a significant step in resolving that issue."

But it remained unclear Wednesday whether the offer would coax the attorneys back to work, as they were seeking a much larger pay raise: \$35-an-hour more this year and \$25-an-hour the following year. At

**LAWMAKERS, Page A10**

**An Army helicopter was flying higher than it should have been** when it collided with a passenger plane over Washington, killing 67 people. **A2.**

**Senate Democrats moved to compel the Trump administration to release material** tied to the investigation into Jeffrey Epstein. **A3.**

**The trade deadline is here** and Red Sox players and fans are hoping the team will be active. **C1.**



**Drench in the works**

**Thursday:** Showers, cooler. High 74-79. Low 58-63.

**Friday:** Rain ends early. High 65-70. Low 57-62.

High tide: 4:33 a.m., 4:56 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:36 Sunset: 8:05

**Weather and Comics, D5-6. Obituaries, C9.**

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